C1 Grammar

Participle clauses

Combine ideas with -ing, past participle and having + past participle clauses for a tighter, more formal style.

A participle clause replaces a full clause with a participle. It makes writing shorter and more formal, and is common in reports, essays and news.

Type	Full clause	Participle clause
Present participle (active, same time)	*As she walked home, she saw an accident.*	*Walking home, she saw an accident.*
Past participle (passive)	*The book, which was written in 1990, is still popular.*	*Written in 1990, the book is still popular.*
Perfect participle (earlier action)	*After he had finished the report, he left.*	*Having finished the report, he left.*
Reason	*Because I didn't know the way, I took a taxi.*	*Not knowing the way, I took a taxi.*
Reduced relative clause	*Students who live on campus pay less.*	*Students living on campus pay less.*

Negatives. Put *not* before the participle: *Not wanting to be late, we left early.*

Dangling participles. The subject of the participle must be the subject of the main clause. *Walking into the room, the lights went off* means the lights were walking. Say *Walking into the room, I noticed the lights go off.*

Practice

Rewrite using a participle clause.

1. As I opened the door, I heard a noise.

2. After she had read the email, she called her manager.
3. The products, which are made in Oman, are sold worldwide.
4. Because he didn't have a ticket, he couldn't enter.
5. People who work from home save time.
6. Correct the dangling participle: Arriving late, the meeting had already started.

▼ **Show answers**

1. Opening the door, I heard a noise.
2. Having read the email, she called her manager.
3. Made in Oman, the products are sold worldwide.
4. Not having a ticket, he couldn't enter.
5. People working from home save time.
6. Arriving late, I found that the meeting had already started.